CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 3

PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- She wants to purchase tickets.
- She is interested in what shows are on.
- She is unable to use her ticket.
- She wants to complain to the manager.

Question 2 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- It has been playing for several weeks.
- It just started playing this week.
- It only plays Tuesdays and Wednesdays.
- It will be playing for several more weeks.

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- to confirm he can exchange the tickets
- to double-check the show's last day
- to request the manager speak to the woman
- to ask permission to give a refund

Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- to explain which shows are the best
- to tell what is playing in February
- to explain which shows are musicals
- to tell what is playing that season

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- to figure out when she'd like to see the show
- to figure out which show she'd like to see
- to see if she has enough money for the ticket
- to assist someone in line behind her

Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- in the green section
- in the balcony section
- in the red section
- in the middle of a row

Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

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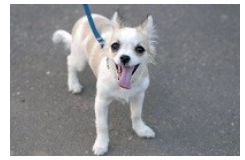
- 
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Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- tell her daughter about the show
- give the extra ticket to her friend
- turn off the sound on her cellphone
- purchase a camera for the show

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ because she didn't cook dinner
- ◯ because she didn't buy the right ingredients
- ◯ because her guests will no longer come
- ◯ because dinner didn't turn out as expected

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ Order some food in.
- ◯ Make some sushi.
- ◯ Make another pizza.
- ◯ Have chicken and salad.

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ because the food wasn't good
- ◯ because it's too far away
- ◯ because they don't deliver
- ◯ because it's far too late

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ Bake a frozen pizza.
- ◯ Cook a vegetarian meal.
- ◯ Have sushi and cheesecake.
- ◯ Have beef pasta and soup.

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ They were cooks at a restaurant.
- ◯ They went to college together.
- ◯ They are co-workers.
- ◯ They are roommates.

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ on an organic fruit farm.
- ◯ in a food research centre.
- ◯ in a countryside guest house.
- ◯ in Canadian forest lands.

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- ◯ three months of fun work.
- ◯ a visa and free accommodation.
- ◯ meals and a place to sleep.
- ◯ an opportunity to develop skills.

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ She is studying organic agriculture.
- ◯ She is travelling and visiting friends.
- ◯ She is studying and doing research.
- ◯ She is finding a place to live.

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ She will start work in the early morning.
- ◯ She will start work at midday.
- ◯ She will start work at different times.
- ◯ She will start work after feeding the goats.

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ a big city.
- ◯ the United States.
- ◯ a small town.
- ◯ Castlegar.

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer to each question

- ◯ She thinks it will be a fun experience.
- ◯ The work experience will help her career.
- ◯ She wants to be with her friend.
- ◯ She wants to apply for a work visa.

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. Black bears are _____
- ◯ disrupting traffic in town
- ◯ threatening people in parks
- ◯ being seen closer to town
- ◯ hiding in urban areas

2. The current problem is due to _____
- ◯ bears being harassed by people
- ◯ bears suffering from garbage poisoning
- ◯ heat and lack of food in bear habitat
- ◯ city construction in bear habitat

3. According to the wildlife official, residents should _____
- ◯ stay indoors as much as possible.
- ◯ keep their garbage indoors or locked.
- ◯ attract bears away from their homes.
- ◯ call the city to collect their garbage.

4. A local resident, Ms. Nelson _____
- ◯ is worried about bear attacks.
- ◯ found a novel way to help the bears.
- ◯ is concerned about damages to the city.
- ◯ is annoyed by the smell of garbage.

5. The city is providing residents with _____
- ◯ new animal-proof garbage cans
- ◯ more frequent garbage collection services
- ◯ individual consultations with wildlife officials
- ◯ information about how to keep bears away

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. What is most probably true of all three people?
- ◯ They will be teaching science courses.
- ◯ They will be using the same office chair.
- ◯ They will meet with Human Resources next.
- ◯ They will go out to celebrate afterwards.

2. Why are they meeting?
- ◯ to choose who will get which piece of office furniture
- ◯ to coordinate their schedules so as to share the office
- ◯ to decide how best to rearrange the office furniture
- ◯ to determine how to share the available office space

3. What is good about the room?
- ◯ the carpet colour
- ◯ the floor layout
- ◯ the location
- ◯ the natural light

4. Where will Ivan put his personal belongings?
- ◯ in the desk drawer
- ◯ in a filing cabinet
- ◯ on a bookcase shelf
- ◯ on the table

5. What item would they like to avoid sharing?
- ◯ the desk
- ◯ the filing cabinet
- ◯ the bookcase
- ◯ the table

6. How does Ivan feel about having a whiteboard?
- ◯ He has no real desire for a whiteboard.
- ◯ He instead wants only a bulletin board.
- ◯ He'd like to start using a whiteboard.
- ◯ He'd prefer a traditional blackboard.

PART 5

7. What do the women intend to use the small table for?

- refreshments
- office supplies
- books and files
- student visits

8. What is most likely true of Reena?

- She collects antique carpets.
- She is allergic to chalk dust.
- She gets lost in large buildings.
- She prefers tea over coffee.

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. According to the passage, the movement toward creating multicultural societies _____

- has reached an unprecedented level worldwide.
- is growing in popularity in Germany and France.
- has been rather unsuccessful in North America.
- is a newly adopted trend in Canadian politics.

2. German Chancellor Merkel seems to feel that multiculturalism _____

- has led to improved demographics.
- should be improved upon as a policy.
- will help grow the European population.
- has created more problems than benefits.

3. Sociologist Arlene Brandon believes multiculturalism is failing in nations that _____

- have neglected to implement truly inclusive policies.
- are experiencing the greatest demographic changes.
- have opened their doors to new permanent residents.
- are excessively concerned with political correctness.

4. The passage implies that in Australia _____

- there have been few demographic changes.
- immigrants can eventually become citizens.
- multicultural policies resemble those of France.
- there is very little need for temporary labour.

5. Nora Alkabar would likely encourage people to _____

- focus more on political correctness than multiculturalism.
- ask honest questions of people from different backgrounds.
- be cautious with words when discussing cultural differences.
- consider immigrants to Europe as potential future citizens.

6. The passage was likely part of a _____

- business person's speech.
- college professor's lecture.
- public radio call-in show.
- documentary-style television show.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	She is unable to use her ticket.
Question 2	It has been playing for several weeks.
Question 3	to ask permission to give a refund
Question 4	to tell what is playing that season
Question 5	to figure out when she'd like to see the show
Question 6	in the green section
Question 7	
Question 8	tell her daughter about the show

PART 2	
Question 1	because dinner didn't turn out as expected
Question 2	Make another pizza.
Question 3	because the food wasn't good
Question 4	Cook a vegetarian meal.
Question 5	They went to college together.

PART 3	
Question 1	on an organic fruit farm.
Question 2	meals and a place to sleep.
Question 3	She is travelling and visiting friends.
Question 4	She will start work at different times.
Question 5	the United States.
Question 6	She thinks it will be a fun experience.

PART 4	
Question 1	being seen closer to town
Question 2	heat and lack of food in bear habitat
Question 3	keep their garbage indoors or locked.
Question 4	is annoyed by the smell of garbage.
Question 5	information about how to keep bears away

PART 5	
Question 1	They will be using the same office chair.
Question 2	to determine how to share the available office space
Question 3	the natural light
Question 4	in a filing cabinet
Question 5	the bookcase
Question 6	He has no real desire for a whiteboard.
Question 7	refreshments
Question 8	She prefers tea over coffee.

PART 6	
Question 1	has reached an unprecedented level worldwide.
Question 2	has created more problems than benefits.
Question 3	have neglected to implement truly inclusive policies.
Question 4	immigrants can eventually become citizens.
Question 5	ask honest questions of people from different backgrounds.
Question 6	public radio call-in show.

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You will hear a conversation between a female customer and a male ticket seller. It is taking place in the box office of a local theatre company.

Section 1:

MAN: Hello. May I help you?

WOMAN: Well, I have a problem with these tickets. I got them for my birthday, and they're for tomorrow evening, but I can't come tomorrow. Is there any way I can exchange them?

MAN: Of course. That'll only take a few minutes . . . On which day would you like to see the show?

WOMAN: Tuesday or Wednesday of next week would be best.

MAN: Unfortunately, the show isn't being performed on either of those days. It plays the rest of that week and then it closes.

WOMAN: Darn, that doesn't work for me. Too bad. My friend saw the show a few weeks ago and said it was amazing! Could I get a refund then?

MAN: I'm sorry, we have a policy of no refunds. Only exchanges.

WOMAN: Isn't there anything you can do?

MAN: Well, let me speak to my manager. I'll be right back.

WOMAN: Thanks.

Now answer questions 1-3.

1. Why is the woman speaking to the ticket seller?
2. What is most likely true about the show?
3. Why does the man go speak with his manager?

Section 2:

MAN: Sorry that took so long. Unfortunately, my manager says we can't offer you a refund. But you can exchange these tickets for another show in our season, regardless of ticket price. Would that be ok?

WOMAN: I guess so. What other shows are playing this year?

MAN: Our next play is MacBeth—

WOMAN: (hmm) A tragedy? No, I wouldn't like that.

MAN: We also have Blithe Spirit, which is a comedy, and Beauty and the Beast, a musical.

WOMAN: I love musicals! I'd like to see that one!

MAN: On which day would you like to see the show? It runs the entire month of February.

WOMAN: I'll need a minute—why don't you help the next person in line.

Now answer questions 4-5.

4. Why does the man give the names of several shows?
5. Why does the woman need a minute?

Transcripts

Section 3:

WOMAN: Hi, I'm back! I'd like tickets for the February 4th performance.

MAN: Alright . . . Now let me turn my computer screen around so you can see . . . there. This is our online seating chart. All of the seats in green are currently available; the ones in red are taken. Unfortunately, our balcony will be closed for renovations during February.

WOMAN: Let's see . . . I'd like those two in the fifth row in the middle — no, sorry, I mean at the end. The two at the end.

MAN: Okay . . . done! Now, just a reminder that you aren't allowed to bring cameras into the theatre. Food and drink are also prohibited, but can be enjoyed outside in the lobby. Cell phones are allowed but must be turned off. Anything else I can do for you?

WOMAN: Actually, now that I think of it, I'd like to get a third ticket for the same performance. My daughter would love to see it.

MAN: No problem . . . that'll be sixty-eight dollars, then.

WOMAN: Here you go.

MAN: Thanks! Enjoy the show!

Now answer questions 6-8.

6. What is likely true about the man?
7. How does the woman help the man?
8. What is the man's reaction to the woman's response?

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You will hear a conversation between a husband and wife. They have guests coming over for dinner tonight.

MAN: Hey honey, I'm back! The wine was on sale, so I bought two bottles instead of one. How's the pizza coming?

WOMAN: I just ruined it! I put the oven temperature way too high by accident. The crust is all black and burnt! It's totally inedible! And Judy and Paul are supposed to arrive any minute now!

MAN: Don't worry, it's not the end of the world! Do we have anything else to prepare for dinner? Is there any pizza dough left? Maybe we could make the pizza again.

WOMAN: I used up all the dough. There's no more tomato sauce or cheese either. All we have is salad, and a whole frozen chicken, but that won't thaw fast enough.

MAN: Well, we could always go out for pizza! There's that place a few blocks down the road, Golden Pizza House.

WOMAN: Ugh, not that place. We went there before, remember? The pizza was soggy and the sauce was too salty.

MAN: Yeah, you're right. It wasn't very good. Well, there aren't that many other restaurants around here, except for sushi. But we have chocolate cheesecake for dessert. Cheesecake doesn't really go very well with sushi. Hmm . . . We still have vegetables, right?

WOMAN: Yeah, there are plenty of vegetables. Isn't that a bit boring, though?

MAN: It'll be fine. Judy used to be a vegetarian when I first met her in college. In fact, she taught me how to cook quite a few dishes! All I ever ate was beef pasta and canned soup before we became friends. Anyways, let's see. We can make stuffed zucchini, and cream of mushroom soup. That will go nicely with dessert!

WOMAN: Really? You're such a good cook now! I bet you wouldn't have burnt the pizza. But you're right, let's make the best of it. Stuffed zucchini sounds yummy! And we still have the salad, too!

MAN: Exactly. And we have two bottles of wine. See? Dinner isn't ruined. It's going to be delicious! Let's start on the vegetables, before Judy and Paul get here.

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. Why is the woman troubled?
2. What is the man's first suggestion?
3. Why did they decide against Golden Pizza House?
4. What do the couple decide to do?
5. How did the man meet one of the guests?

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman. The woman is looking for volunteer work.

MAN: Hello, Juicy Apple Orchards, this is Michael speaking! How may I help you?

WOMAN: Hi there! My name is Anna Howard. I've been backpacking in Canada for the past three months, and I really wanted to experience working on an organic farm this summer! I met another traveler who told me about your farm and that you take volunteers. Is that right?

MAN: That's right! We've been offering free accommodation and food in exchange for fruit picking for the last ten years! It's a great way to have fun, experience what life is like in the Canadian countryside, and meet amazing people from around the world.

WOMAN: I would love to do that! How many hours a week is it, and what are the duties to be done?

MAN: We ask our volunteers to work 4 to 5 hours a day, and we schedule rotating shifts for people. As we're primarily an orchard, every shift will involve apple picking. The early morning shift workers also feed the chickens, the noon workers also turn the compost, and the evening workers also feed the goats!

WOMAN: That sounds really fun! So how do I start?

MAN: You could start anytime! We've got quite a few volunteers right now. Still, there are five rooms left in our volunteer guest house! But I have to ask you first, are you over the age of 18, and are you a Canadian resident?

WOMAN: I'm 23, and I'm from the States. I'm on a holiday visa. Is that acceptable, or do I need a working visa?

MAN: Great! No, you don't need a working visa to volunteer on Canadian farms as long as you don't stay longer than four weeks.

WOMAN: That works perfectly, as I'm going back home in three weeks anyways! Your farm is in Peachland, right? I'm in Castlegar right now, visiting a friend. It's Tuesday today . . . would I be able to arrive on Friday?

MAN: Yes, we're in Peachland! Friday sounds good! We'll prepare a room for you. See you then!

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. Where does the woman want to volunteer?
2. What does the man offer the woman?
3. Why is the woman in Canada?
4. What time will the woman start work each day?
5. Where does the woman come from?
6. Why does the woman want to volunteer?

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news item about a bear problem.

Residents living on the outskirts of Chapel Hill are being asked to put a tight lid on their garbage because of an increase in black bear sightings. Parks and Wildlife Official, Gary Hampton, explained that the recent heat wave has dried up several of the black bears' natural food sources, such as berry bushes and fishing streams, forcing the bears to seek food near urban areas. Hampton warns residents of Chapel Hill that, "Garbage provides a variety of appetizing foods for a hungry bear and the best way to avoid problems with bears in the backyard is to keep garbage cans in the garage or the house until they can be collected by city workers." A local resident, Sandra Nelson, complains that keeping her garbage in the house is not an acceptable solution. Yet, what smells bad to most people can be very appetizing to a hungry bear. The aroma of garbage can attract bears from far away. So, if residents must put their garbage outside, Hampton advises them to purchase animal-proof garbage cans. These cans have lids that are difficult for animals to remove. Not only do the cans keep animals away from the garbage, but they also keep the garbage smells from attracting the animals.

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a discussion among three people. There are two women and one man. They are at their office.

Lynn: Hello, you must be Ivan! I'm Lynn, Chemistry.

Ivan: Hello, Lynn. Yes, Ivan. Math.

Reena: And I'm Reena, Biology. Sorry that I'm late — I had a little trouble finding the room! So . . . we're the new part-time instructors! Congratulations to us!

Ivan: Hear! Hear! I think we should all go out and celebrate, once we get this all figured out [gesturing the space]!

Lynn: [looking around] I can understand why the Human Resources person wanted us to meet. It's awfully tight in here, isn't it? I don't even think there's room enough for three desks! [pause] At least there's window though!

Reena: I don't even think there's enough room for two desks. Let's hope that our schedules work out and one person wants to use the office in the mornings, another in the afternoons, and a third in the evenings. This carpet is ancient! I love it!

Lynn: Let's ask for a desk that at least has drawers on both sides. I could use the ones on the left . . .

Ivan: And Reena can take the drawers on the right. And I'll take one of the draws on the filing cabinet. That still leaves one drawer for each of us for our files! I think that should be enough. I would imagine most of us use our laptops for our files.

Reena: Sounds good. Do you think then that means we could have three bookcases, one for each of us?

Ivan: I'd like that! I don't mind sharing the desk or a filing cabinet, but I want my own bookcase!

Lynn: Me too. If we move the filing cabinet over here and the table over there, maybe there's room on that wall for three bookcases. Um, we'll also need a chair for the desk and one for students, for office hours, to go over papers, answer questions . . . And a whiteboard over there?

Reena: So much better than a blackboard! I hate getting chalk all over your fingers, and then all over your clothes . . .

Ivan: Well . . . I guess I can get used to a whiteboard. I also think we should have a bulletin board over above the desk? For notices, schedules, meetings, what have you. And . . . we're gonna need some whiteboard markers and thumbtacks . . .

Lynn: Good idea. I can bring a coffee maker. A tin of biscuits . . . That table is pretty small but I think it'll do . . .

Reena: I hope your coffee maker is not too big. I'd like to bring a tea kettle, and I'm sure we all have our mugs we want to put there.

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear a report about multiculturalism policies.

Multicultural societies are more prevalent around the globe than ever before. Canada is often credited for instigating this movement back in 1971 when Prime Minister, Pierre Elliot Trudeau, declared Canada to be a multicultural nation. Trudeau envisioned a country which recognized and respected the contribution by various ethnic groups to the cultural enrichment of Canada, and he implemented policies to safeguard that contribution.

However, the German Chancellor, Angela Merkel, recently declared the policy of multiculturalism a failure. There have been significant demographic changes in many countries over the last decades; unfortunately, in some nations, this has resulted in inter-cultural tensions. Thus, other European countries have also condemned multiculturalism as a passing fad that does not actually promote unity in today's diverse societies.

Sociologist Arlene Brandon argues that these countries cannot condemn a practice that they've never really attempted to properly implement. Brandon's research on the success of multiculturalism has shown a strong correlation between citizenship and multiculturalism. The nations that have most successfully adopted a policy of multiculturalism are those that have allowed immigrants to eventually become citizens, thus creating a strong sense of unity and inclusion. Presently, Canada and Australia are the most multicultural countries and, because of their policies, their demographic changes have generally occurred peacefully and positively. France, Norway, and Germany, on the other hand, have failed to truly adopt multiculturalism since they treat foreigners as temporary labour and not as future citizens. Brandon says these countries should not blame multiculturalism for their problems, but, rather, their poorly designed policies.

However, not everyone agrees that Canada's multiculturalism has been successful. According to controversial author Nora Alkabar, present day multiculturalism, as practiced in Canada, encourages segregation and hyper political correctness. Alkabar argues that multiculturalism and diversity are not the same thing. She says that diversity refers to differences in thoughts, opinions, and viewpoints, whereas multiculturalism involves equality and mutual respect among a population's cultural groups. She maintains that multiculturalism should mean engaging with others in a meaningful way about their assumptions and goals. Alkabar says that Canadians today are so worried about offending someone or saying the wrong thing that they don't engage with other cultures or ask questions they may have, which she finds disrespectful. Alkabar claims that a true multicultural society is built on mutual respect and hopes that the next generations engage with each other more honestly.

What do you think, Canada? Is it time to have a frank and honest conversation about multiculturalism in our nation? We'd love to hear from you after this commercial break.